

Stat 5101, Spring 2026. Homework 1

The main goal of this homework is to establish a meaningful connection between instructors and students participating in this class, identify group preferences, and ensure everyone is ready to use R and Gradescope.

Please answer the following questions. The first step in submitting your answers will be to create a **single pdf document** including your answers for all questions. After submitting the document, you will have to *map your answers to the questions* in Gradescope. Here is [a link to a short](#) and very helpful tutorial on how to do this. (You can go straight to 1:40min if you only need to see the part about matching answers and pages.)

General instructions for this homework only: you will be required to submit answers that cover the most common types of submission: typed answers, handwritten and scanned, and include an image. Please read carefully the instructions for each of the questions to ensure you submit the homework in the right format. For the remainder of the semester, you will choose the modality of submission that works best for you. This assignment is intended to give you practice with each of the more popular modes of submission, so you can verify it works and receive feedback regarding improvements. Please note that exams will also be submitted via Gradescope, and thus getting practice with the steps of submission will ensure your exams are submitted in a timely manner.

This assignment will also provide the opportunity to learn how to map your answers to the questions in Gradescope. Please ask for help if you can't figure out how to do the mapping and make sure you understand how to do this for Homework 1. We are happy to help and guide you through the process, so let us know if you need help. However, no future assignments will be graded that do not have the answers mapped to the question numbers in Gradescope.

Question 1: Background information

For this question, please type your answers.

- a) Your name (and what you prefer to be called).
- b) Your major and when you started it at ISU.
- c) Previous relevant Statistics courses that you have taken in the past (e.g. Stat 1010, 326, or from another institution). Indicate concurrent, if taking this semester. Which of these classes was most difficult for you, and why?
- d) Describe any other experiences with statistical analysis (e.g., in your job, as an intern, or in research).
- e) What is your expertise with R? Have you used it before? Are you familiar with RStudio? ggplot? R Markdown?

Question 2:

For this question, please type your answers.

- a) Share one experience (school, work, or personal) where data or numbers played an important role in a decision you made.
- b) If you could turn any dataset into a story, what kind of story would it be (mystery, comedy, adventure, drama)?
- c) If you could instantly master a skill (academic or not), what would it be?

Question 3: Team membership

For this question, please write your answers by hand, scan them and append them to the homework document. Instructions on how to produce good scans are on Canvas, under the **Start Here Module**, in the **i** Preparing Digital Content link.

- a) Please list here the names of your course mates who have agreed to work with you on the course team project. If you prefer to be assigned to a group, please say so here.
- b) What skills will you be bringing to your team for the project? Examples include skills such as extensive R programming experience, or experience with presentation (written and oral), strong analytical skills, access to large data bases, or anything else that you know will make you a valuable team member.

Question 4: Submit an image created by you using R

Follow the code explained and provided in Lab01, create a meaningful graph for describing the data in the **creativity** data set. Save the graph and include it in your homework submission document. You may choose the graph to submit. This question is set up to ensure you can follow the steps for installing R and following the R script and instructions, as well as provide practice with submitting high quality images-- as you will need to do both for future assessments.